

Kudzaishe Zharare

kudzi@alum.mit.edu | kudzaishe.com | github.com/kudzaishezharare

Experience

Poza

2025 - Present

Founder and Software Engineer

- Turned 56 discovery interviews into product requirements and technical designs; built Flutter workflows and TypeScript APIs for identity and payments in development and sandbox
- Designed PostgreSQL wallet accounting and reconciliation to prevent duplicate deposit credits and keep balances traceable to settled funds
- Architected AWS infrastructure with CDK and CI/CD pipelines, making environment setup repeatable and validating configurations with automated tests
- Designed AI agent workflows with human approval checkpoints; built a read-only runtime with scoped tools and automated access-control tests

Cleva Technologies (YC W24)

Apr 2024 - 2025

Lead Software Engineer

- Reduced identity verification waits from 2 days to 3 weeks to under a minute for eligible completed submissions by automating document checks and decision workflows
- Built verification infrastructure used as the platform grew beyond 1 million users, including duplicate detection and reasoned referral of uncertain cases for manual review
- Reduced liveness-check failures on low-end phones by addressing crashes and camera-image errors, narrowing the observed verification-completion gap with an external provider

FlexID Technologies

2021 - 2023

CTO, later Co-Founder

- Built self-sovereign identity wallets with verifiable credentials, enabling users to hold and present digital records across mobile and web applications
- Applied zero-knowledge proofs and selective disclosure to verify claims without exposing full records
- Led a distributed engineering team delivering wallet applications, encrypted credential handling, backend services, and cloud infrastructure

Motapa, trading as Mutapa

2020 - 2021

Founder and Systems Architect

- Led a 5-person team delivering merchant payment systems across education, retail, and healthcare; coordinated bank liaison, integration testing, and merchant training
- Built Mutapa Marketplace, acquired by CBZ Holdings; continued payment support through 2022

The World Bank

2019 - 2020

Country Lead Engineer, DRIVER Project (SDC contract)

- Built a national crash-reporting application and dashboards; coordinated rollout with police, ambulance services, and the Ministry of Health

Skills

Applications: TypeScript, Python, React, Node.js, Flutter

Cloud and data: AWS, AWS CDK, PostgreSQL, CI/CD

AI and testing: Agent orchestration, Playwright, Vitest

Education

Massachusetts Institute of Technology

2019

B.S. in Computer Science and Mathematics